

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE - 17

**SATAVAHANA
DYNASTY**

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

SANGAM AGE

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

POST MAURYAN ERA

COMPARISON

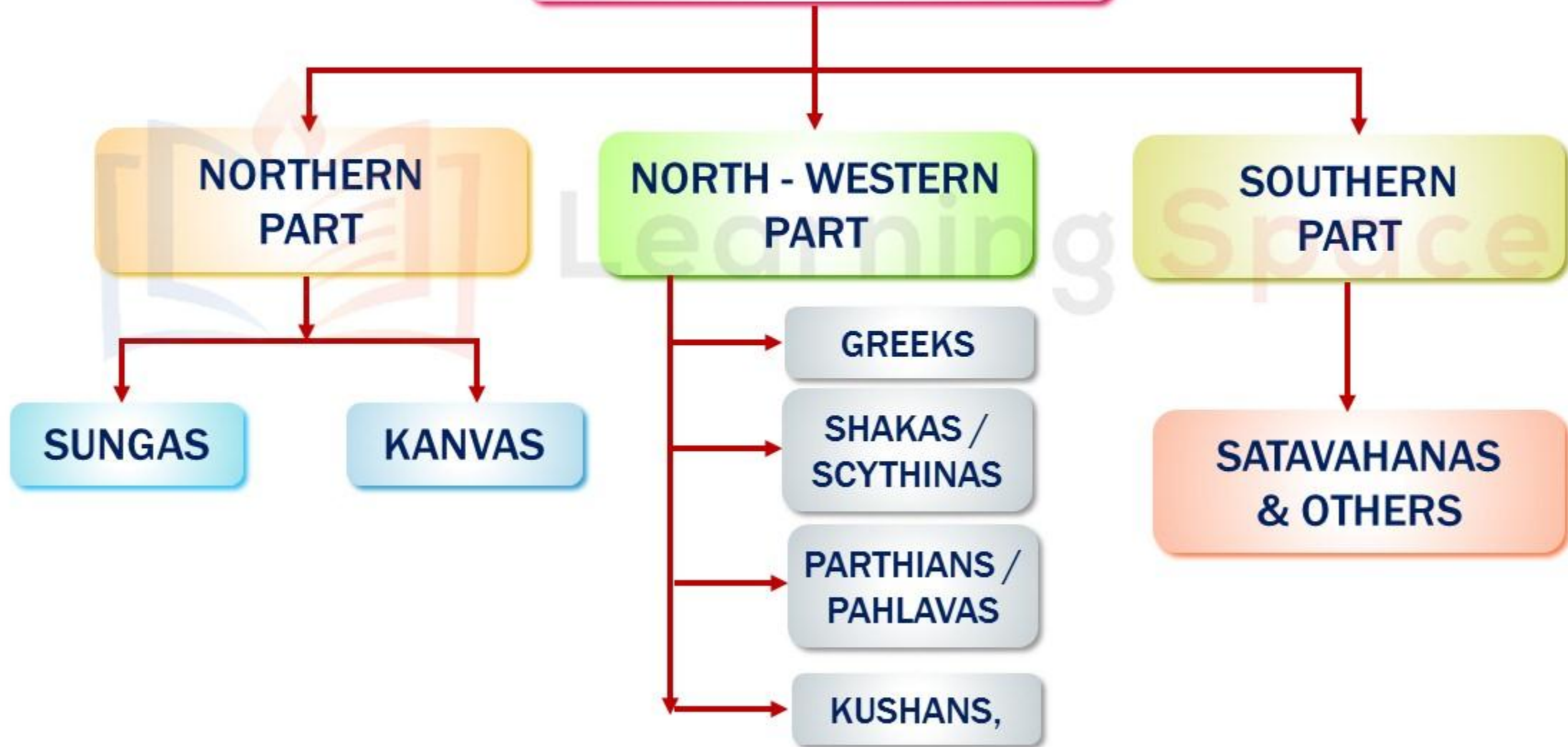
NEW PHASE



1. DISINTEGRATION
2. DECENTRALISATION
3. BRAHMINICAL REVIVALISM
4. LINGUISTIC REVIVALISM - SANSKRIT
5. FOREIGN INVASION



POST MAURYAN PHASE





SATAVAHANA DYNASTY

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(1ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

BACKGROUND

WHO WERE SATAVAHANAS AND HOW THEY CAME TO THE POWER?

There are many theories regarding the origin of Satavahanas and hence it is a matter of debate.

1

NANAGHAT INSCRIPTION

- Mentions Satavahana rule but not Andhra rule.
- Simuka was mentioned as the first king

2

PURANAS

- Puranas mention about Andhra rule not Satavahana rule
- First Andhra king overthrow Kanva and came to power.

3

HISTORIANS

- Satavahanas originated in Andhra region and moved west ward and **established the power in Western Deccan .**

In Deccan, they established their independent rule after the decline of the Mauryas, and rule lasted for about 450 years.



IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

PAKISTAN

CHINA

INDIA

NEPAL

BHUTAN

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

OMAN

Arabian Sea

SHAKA

Pataliputra

Kanva

★ Pratishthana

**SATAVAHANA
EMPIRE**

• Amaravati

Bay of Bengal

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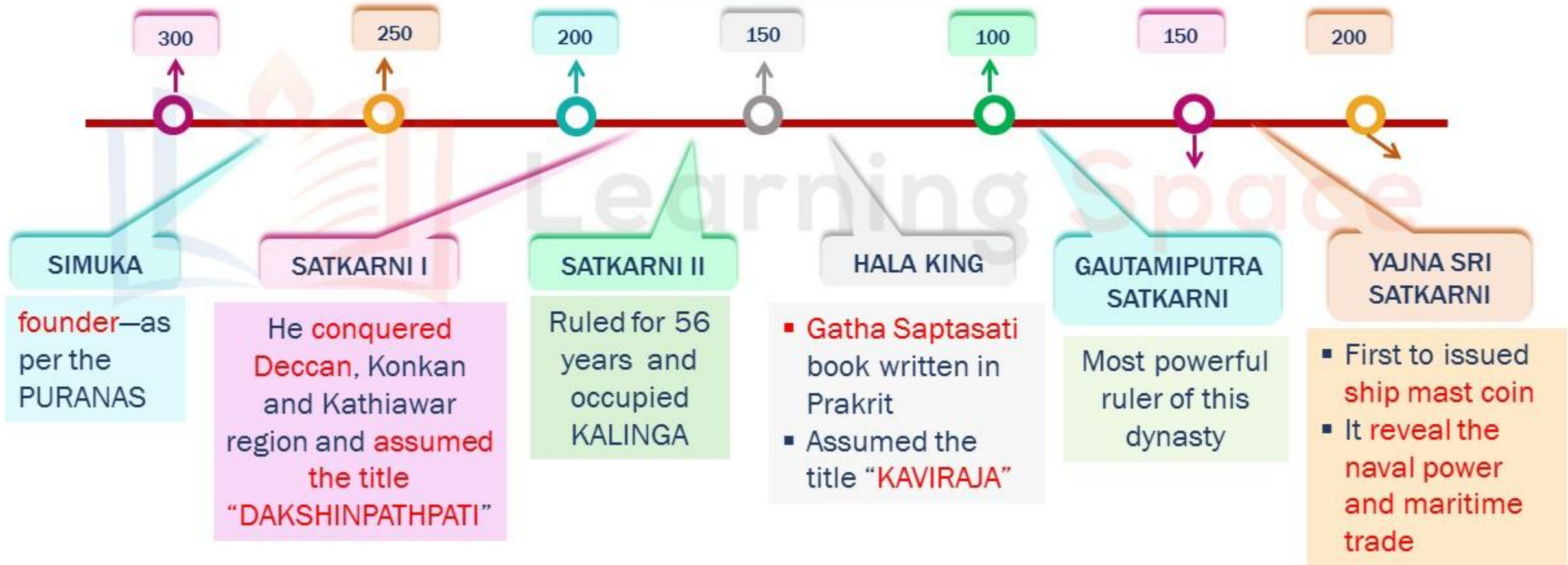
HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

GENEALOGY



SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

GAUTAMIPUTRA SATKARNI

- 1 His achievements were recorded in Nasik inscription by his mother Gautami Balasri.
- 2 He was known as *Destroyer of the Shaka, Pahalava and Yavana Power*.
- 3 He revived the system of matronymics i.e name derived from the name of mother or female ancestor.
- 4 He called himself as **EKA BRAHMANA**. i.e. unique (peerless) Brahmin or Brahman who is beyond comparison.
- 5 He **patronized Brahmanism**. But he also gave donations to Buddhists.
- 6 He stopped mixing of four Varnas to restore the varnas system.
- 7 First ruler to issue portrait type of coins.



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(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

HOW SATAVAHANAS CONSOLIDATED THEIR EMPIRE?

Performed Ashvamedha and Rajasuya yajna done to assert imperial sovereignty.

Land donations to legitimise their authority and to accept the suzerainty of imperial power.

Patronising Brahmanism and Buddhism to get social acceptance

Taking advantage of turmoil caused by Greek invasions in Northern India they established their rule.

- Diplomatic means.
- war tactics and conquests.

Matrimonial relation-
Vashistaputra Satakarni was married to daughter of Rudradaman, the Shaka ruler.



TACTICS ADOPTED

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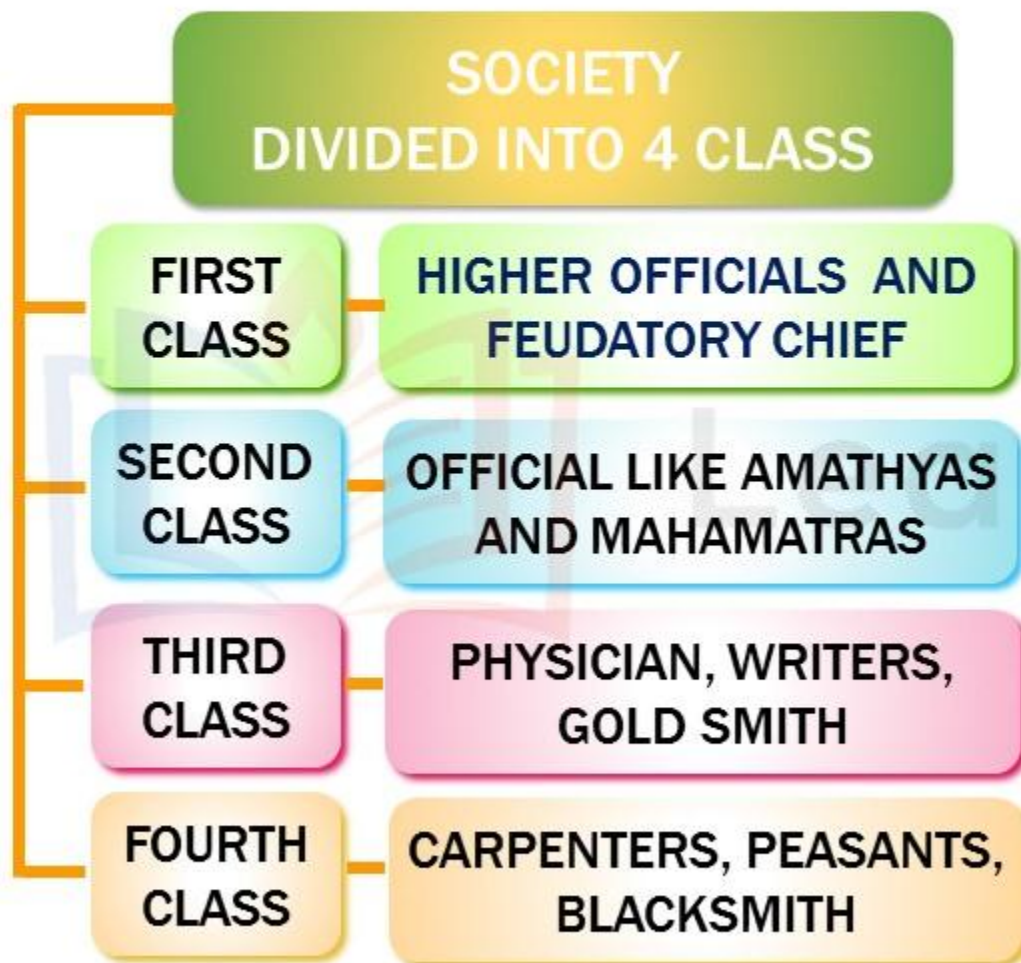
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SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

SOCIAL STRUCTURE

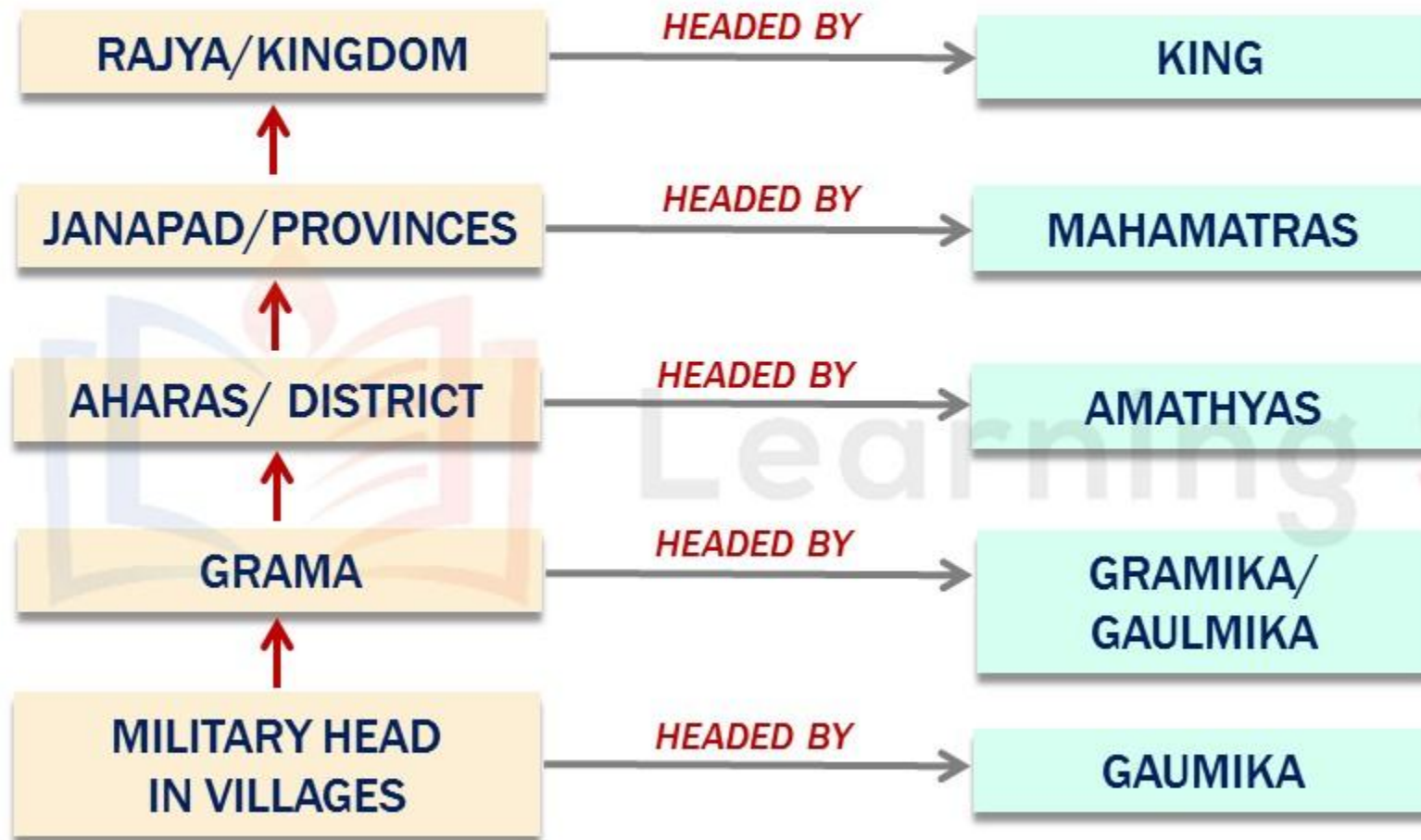


- 1 Deccan tribes were gradually Brahmanised.
- 2 They uphold the *varna* system and prevented mixing of Varnas.
- 3 Gender division of patronage, men performed *vedic practices* and women of the family were generous donors of Buddhist sangha.
- 4 Women were honoured and given higher education and allowed to participate in religious practices.

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

POLITICAL STRUCTURE



- Satavahanas administration was simple and inspired by the Mauryas.
- Post of Amatya was not hereditary but based on merit.
- Special officer called **Uparakshita** designated as main authority to build caves for the monks

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

ECONOMIC CONDITION

AGRICULTURE

They knew the art of paddy transplantation and cultivation of cotton. Godavari formed a great rice bowl.



MERCHANTS

- Merchants organized guilds to increase their activities.
- Different guilds of craftsmen such as potters, weavers and oil pressers.



CURRENCY

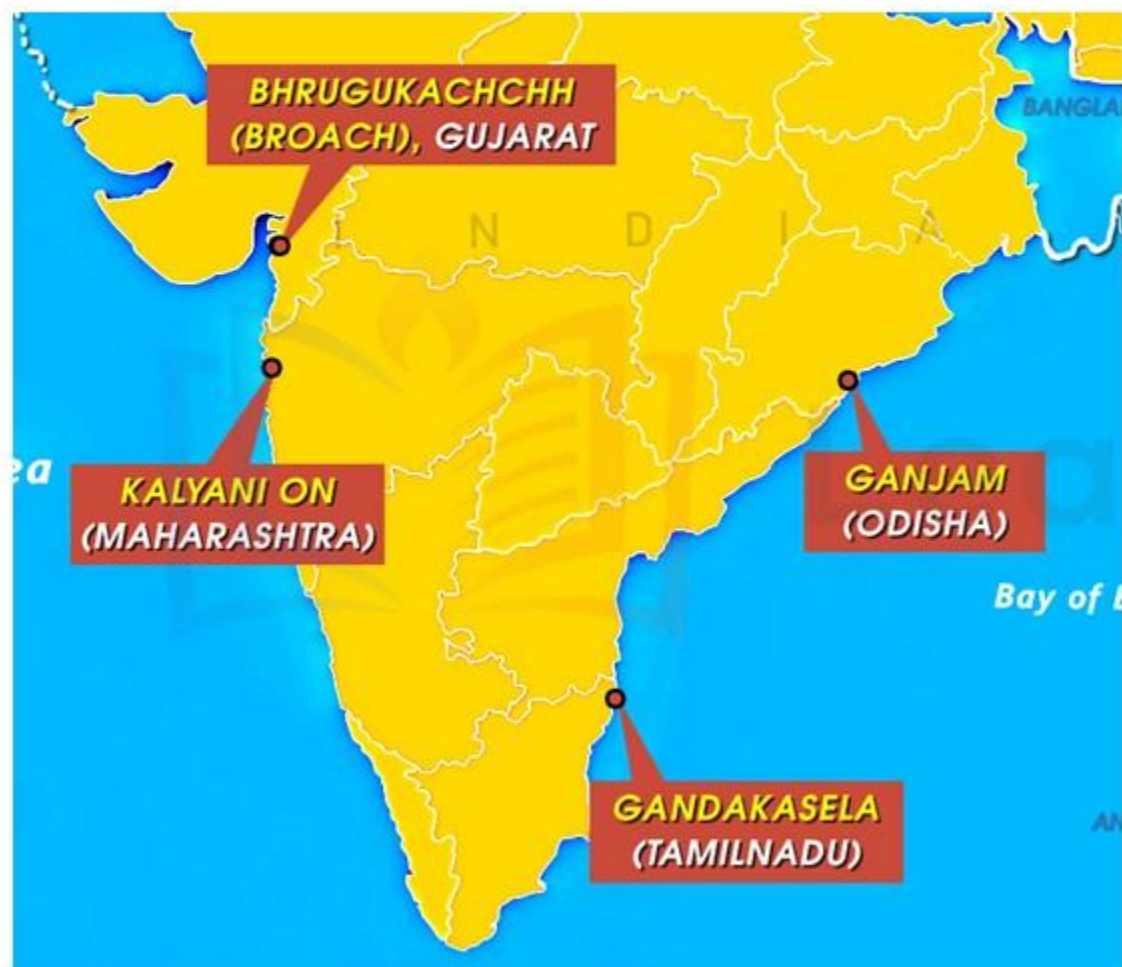
- Unlike Kushan empire Satavahanas minted more of lead coins.
- Silver coins called Karshapanas.



SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

ECONOMIC CONDITION



TRADING PORTS

- 1 • Involved in overseas commercial activity.
• Ptolemy, mentions of many ports in the Deccan region.
- 2 Greatest port was **Kalyani** on the west Deccan.
- 3 **Gandakasela** and **Ganjam** on the east coast.

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SIGNIFICANCE OR CONTRIBUTION

1 CONNECTIVITY

INTRA-CONNECTIVITY

- 1 Satavahanas acted as a bridge between North and South India, hence called as **BRIDGE KINGDOM**
- 2 The material culture of north gradually transferred to south paving the way for rise of territorial kingdoms in south
- 3 The material culture of Satavahanas was a **fusion of both local Deccan elements as well as northern ingredients.**

INTER-CONNECTIVITY

- 4 They maintain the relations with South-East Asia.
- 5 They maintained contacts with Roman empire which shows Satavahanas economy was interconnected with global economy

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

SIGNIFICANCE OR CONTRIBUTION

1 CONNECTIVITY

NORTHERN FEATURES IMBIBED BY SATAVAHANAS

- 1 Learnt the art of extraction of minerals from Magadha region
 - exploited iron from Karimnagar and Warangal region.
 - and gold from Kolar region



ROYAL EAR RINGS

- 2 Use of fire-baked bricks and the use of flat, perforated roof tiles (as used in Kushans) which must have aided in the longevity of the construction



SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

SIGNIFICANCE OR CONTRIBUTION

1 CONNECTIVITY

NORTHERN FEATURES IMBIBED BY SATAVAHANAS

- 3 They are considered *flag bearers of Aryanism to Deccan*.



- 4 Drains were covered and underground (like indus valley civilization) to lead waste water into soakage pits.

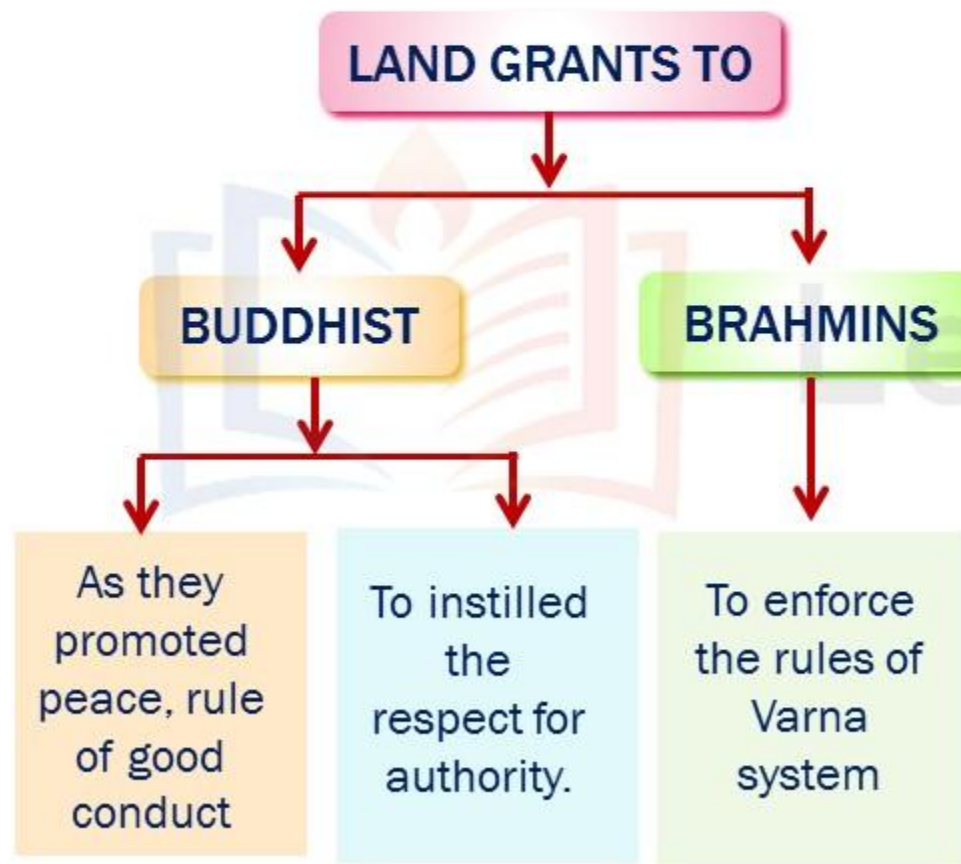


SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

SIGNIFICANCE OR CONTRIBUTION

2 TAX FREE LAND GRANTS



1 The earliest(first) **tax free land grant** of India was issued by Satavahanas called as **Agraharas**.

2 Though they favored brahmins, they also gave land grants to Buddhist also.

*Agraharas are tax free villages, not to be dug for salt, free from intrusion from royal police and soldiers and enjoy all sorts of **pariharas** or immunities. Hence they became small independent islands within the kingdom.*

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

SIGNIFICANCE OR CONTRIBUTION

3 CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE

- 1 They opened new vistas in Buddhist art. They built many stupas, chaityas and viharas



KARLE CHAITYA
IN THE WESTERN
DECCAN
BELONGS TO
THIS ERA.

- 2 Most prominent stupas were built at Amravati, Nagarjunakonda and Jaggayyapetta.



AMARAVATI
STUPA



NAGARJUNAKONDA
STUPA

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

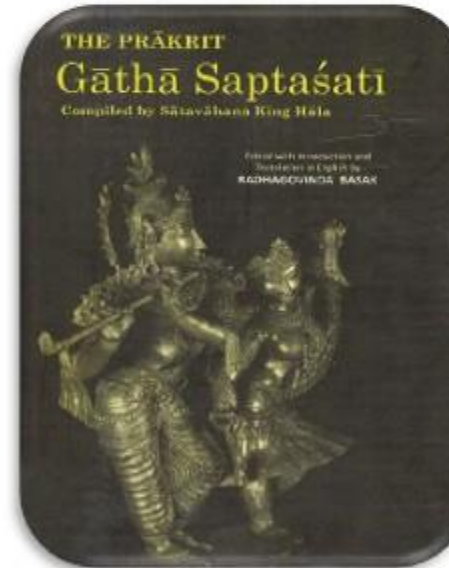
SIGNIFICANCE OR CONTRIBUTION

3 CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE

- 3 Their coins have bilingual legends (Prakrit and some Dravida language). Prakrit seems to be the official language of Satavahanas. They were first native Indians who had issued coins with portraits of kings.



- 4 They promoted both Sanskrit and Prakrit.



Ghata Saptasati of King Hala, a book of erotic poems written in Prakrit. Literary genius of king Hala got him a title “Kaviraja”.

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SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

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DECLINE

1 Empire went into hands of **feudatories** and got disintegrated.

2 **Shakas, who were traditional enemies, once again revived** and weakened their power by involving in **constant struggle**.

3 Earlier, **thick vegetation** in south created a barrier for movement. But with the development of material culture in Satavahana rule, **forest were cleared**. It facilitated more internal movement for purpose of **conquest and trade** leading to emergence of new powers.

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POINTS TO PONDER



SATAVAHANA CAPITAL

- 1 Pratisthanapura /paithan was the focal point for Indian culture and civilization.
- 2 Capital at various times included Amaravati, Pratisthanapura and Junnar (Pune)

Koti lingala –

- first capital of Satavahanas, is on the verge of submergence due to backwaters of the sripada yellampalli project on Godhavari river.
- Rare coins of Trimuka –Sriram, Sita and Lakshman were recovered by archeological department.

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

POINTS TO PONDER

HOW WE COME TO KNOW ABOUT THEIR TRADE RELATION?

- 1 During excavation **many coins found** which shows that trade flourished during the period.
- 2 Evidence of large number of roman coins indicate that Satavahana **economy was interconnected with global economy**. Extensive currency system of Satavahanas proved how they were experts at a good administrative system.

WHY MATRonymics?

- 1 It was a **method of identifying the ruler more precisely with the name of the mother as polygamy was common in royal families**.
- 2 Influence of local matrilineal custom.

SATAVAHANAS OF DECCAN

(2ND C BC – 2ND C AD)

SUCCESSOR OF SATAVAHANAS



- 1 Western Satraps in the northwestern part of the kingdom.
- 2 Chutus of Banavasi in North Karnataka. Kadambas of Banavasi in North Karnataka.
- 3 Abhiras in the western part of the kingdom. They were ultimately to succeed the Sātavāhanas in their capital Pratishthānapura.
- 4 Andhra Ikshvakus in the Krishna-Guntur region.
- 5 Pallavas of Kanchipuram, of whom the first ruler was Simhavarman I.

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